TerraManager - Compact user manual

Set up your collection

Create a Box first, then an Animal assigned to an active Box. Skip the optional introduction or replay it from Settings.

1. Add an enclosure

Open Boxes +. Add a name, dimensions and an optional cropped picture. Saving creates the permanent QR identifier. Use Enclosure care in Box details for dated substrate changes, cleaning or water changes, with optional notes. Open it from the top right, next to Edit. Entries stay with the enclosure in Standalone and Shared Care. Add and manage custom types directly from the care history using Custom care types. Archived types remain filterable in history.

2. Add and assign an animal

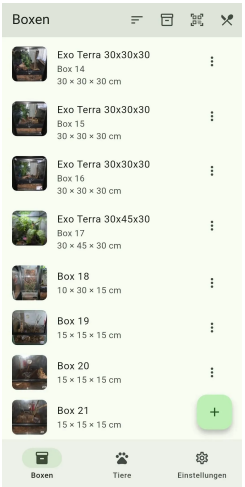
Under Animals +, choose an active Box, category, names and husbandry values. Origin, birth information and other details are optional. Hide Weight or Shedding independently on details without deleting their histories. Under Custom fields Manage field templates in Animal or Box profiles, add text, number, date and yes/no fields. Fill in values when editing. Hiding and archiving preserve data; archived values remain readable.

3. Choose the overview presentation

Use the overview sort control and separate category-group toggle. Settings Appearance offers Big Picture Mode, followed by Show Empty Boxes Last. The latter defaults to off and places Boxes without assigned Animals after occupied Boxes, retaining the chosen sort order within each group.

4. Gallery and Animal PDFs

Add gallery pictures and choose a primary image. Tap a picture for full-screen zoom and navigation. Animal details export either a label with a chosen width and square primary picture, or an A4 profile with feeding, shedding and weight histories in up to three columns. Optionally append all gallery pictures in chronological order, including the primary image, four per page at their original aspect ratios.





Example views; labels may differ with the selected language.

QR codes

A Box QR contains a permanent identifier. The printed label stays valid when Box or Animal data changes.

5. Export Box QR codes

In Settings Box QR codes, select active/archived Boxes and save PNG, ZIP or A4 PDF. PDF code size is adjustable from 6 to 20 mm.

6. Attach and scan

The Box scanner sits above + in the Box overview; Feeding Mode sits above + in the Animal overview. A scanned archived Box offers restoration after confirmation. QR selection during Animal creation chooses the Box; reassignment accepts only another active destination after confirmation. Shared Care scanning requires trusted HTTPS and native browser QR support; only the identifier is sent.

Feedings

Record feeding time and optional notes. Weight and shedding events have their own histories.

7. Feeding history

Open an Animal history to view, correct or delete Feedings. Permanent deletion in Shared Care requires an administrator.

8. Quick feeding by Box scan

Scan or manually choose a Box, select the Animals actually fed, and save the time/notes. Each selected Animal receives an event in one grouped operation.

Wrong Box? Choose “Scan a different Box” to discard the unsaved Feeding draft and return to scanning.

9. Record shedding and weight

Record shedding with date, time and optional notes. Record weight as a positive gram value with its timestamp. Histories are ordered by time and can be corrected later.

Reminders

Choose an interval in days or fixed weekdays with a time and time zone for each Animal.

10. Set an interval or weekdays

Open the reminder action in Animal details. Set a positive day interval or weekdays with a time and IANA zone. Recording a Feeding does not shift a fixed weekday schedule.

11. See which animals are due

Due markers offer Add Feeding or hide overview alerts for 24 hours (per account in Shared Care). Scheduled feedings and detail reminders stay active. Next Feeding opens the schedule. Optionally enable local alerts under Settings Android notifications; off by default, permission requested on enabling. Web and Shared Care keep in-app reminders. Android reports each appointment once, possibly late, without Animal data on the lock screen. Reopen the app after force stop. Hiding alerts for 24 hours does not mute Android notifications.

History

Archived Animals and Boxes keep their data, pictures and histories and can be restored.

12. Preserve and restore archive information

Archive with a reason, date and optional note. A Box must have no active Animals. Sort archives by name or archive date; Restore and Duplicate are available in context menus. Restoring an Animal requires an active destination Box.

Permanent deletion removes archived data irreversibly. In Shared Care, this action is administrator-only.

Backup

Portable .tmbackup files contain the collection, pictures, histories and portable preferences. Restore replaces the target collection.

13. Safety backup before restore

Standalone enables a pre-restore safety copy by default; you may disable it for that operation. Failed or cancelled safety saving stops replacement.

Shared Care requires a current safety copy before replacing existing data. Only a server-confirmed empty collection can skip it. Portable exports exclude accounts; full server recovery needs both databases.

14. Protect a backup with a password

Choose Protect with password and confirm the password. Import asks before processing; a wrong password or damaged file is rejected before replacement. Older unprotected backups remain readable.

A forgotten password cannot be recovered. TerraManager does not persist the backup password. Processing a large backup can take several minutes and fail on low-memory devices. Failure or cancellation leaves the collection unchanged. An enabled local safety copy uses the same password when importing a protected file; Shared Care decrypts in the browser before sending to your own server.

One collection on your own server

Shared Care Web mode lets several caregivers use the same collection through their browsers. Your own server on the local network stores Boxes, Animals, feedings, histories and pictures. The standalone Android and Web applications remain separate.

Access and independent collection

The operator provides a server, local accounts and trusted HTTPS. The Android Shared care setting opens an external browser. Local app data is not automatically synchronized; a portable backup transfers the collection.

Automatic updates

Changes appear on other devices without reloading. After backgrounding or connection loss, the client reconciles server data. Check an unconfirmed save before retrying; there is no offline write queue. Stale drafts cannot silently overwrite newer data.

Controls and presentation

Change names through Edit. Context menus offer applicable care, duplicate, archive and restore actions. Select pictures during creation. Language, sorting and presentation belong to your account; archives stay thumbnail lists.

Roles and sessions

Administrators manage accounts, backups, permanent deletion and audit. Account changes revoke affected sessions; the final active administrator is protected. Sessions expire after twelve hours even during active use; sign in again afterward.

Audit and backup

Local audit records actor, time, action and record identity for 365 days, without notes, pictures or credentials. Administrators filter it under Settings Shared server Audit. Portable backups contain the collection; full server recovery additionally requires both databases.

Shared Care stays separate from standalone collections and requires a reachable LAN server.

Further help

Visual guide and current information

Support / GitHub Issues